

3.3.3 The Quick Mask

Another way to make or edit selections is the Quick Mask Mode, accessed either from the bottom of the toolbox or by hitting [Q] on the keyboard. It lets you “paint” your selections using the paintbrush tool, and even lets you use a whole gamut of other tools to create the selection.

When you paint in the Quick Mask mode, your painting looks like red paint. However, when you exit the Quick Mask mode by hitting [Q] again, the area you painted now becomes a selection.

3.4 Tweaking Selections

All right, so we’ve seen the many ways in which we can make selections, but what do we *do* with them? There’s very little chance that your selection is going to be perfect as soon as you draw it, so you need to take the next step and make it just so.

3.4.1 Moving and Hiding Selections

Once you’ve made a selection, you can move it around by choosing any of the selection tools and moving the mouse cursor within the selection. The cursor will then turn into an arrow with a dotted rectangle. You can now simply click within the selection and drag it around the image. Beware, though; simply clicking and releasing the mouse button in the selection will cause it to de-select.

You can use the arrow keys to nudge the selection in smaller (one pixel at a time, to be precise) steps; hold down [Shift] to turn this into ten pixels at a time.

Sometimes, the dotted line (also referred to as running ants) of the selection boundary can be distracting; you can hide these lines using [Ctrl] + [H], which hides the boundary but keeps the selection intact.